

# Research mode for deep dives

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## Learning objectives

By the end of this lesson, you will be able to:

- Explain what Research does: systematic, multi-source investigation
- Identify when to use Research for comprehensive information gathering
- Understand how Research works with extended thinking to deliver thorough reports
- Write effective Research prompts for complex investigations

## Researching with Claude

### Key takeaways

- **Research transforms how Claude finds and analyzes information.** Instead of a single search, Claude operates agentially—conducting multiple searches that build on each other while determining exactly what to investigate next. It explores different angles of your question automatically and works through open questions systematically.
- **Research delivers comprehensive answers in minutes.** Most reports complete in 5 to 15 minutes, though more complex investigations may take up to 45 minutes—work that would typically require hours of manual research.
- **Extended thinking is automatically enabled with Research.** This powerful combination lets Claude both plan its approach thoughtfully and gather comprehensive information, breaking complex requests into manageable pieces.
- **Citations make verification easy.** Research delivers thorough answers complete with easy-to-check citations, so you can trust Claude's findings and quickly verify sources yourself.

## What is Research?

Research is an advanced feature that transforms Claude from a conversational assistant into a systematic investigator. When you enable Research, Claude doesn't just answer your question—it explores it from multiple angles, synthesizing information from across the web and your connected integrations.

Think of it as having a skilled research assistant who can spend hours gathering information, cross-referencing sources, and compiling a comprehensive report—except it happens in minutes instead of hours.

Research is particularly valuable when you need more than a quick answer. It's designed for situations where a thorough understanding requires pulling together information from multiple sources, comparing different perspectives, and synthesizing findings into actionable insights.

## When to use Research

Understanding when to use Research versus other Claude capabilities helps you get the best results for your specific needs.

### Use Research when you need:

- Comprehensive reports that synthesize information from multiple sources
- In-depth analysis across the web and your connected integrations (like Google Workspace)
- Thorough investigations that would typically require hours of manual work
- Comparative analysis, such as evaluating competitors or vendor options
- Reports with citations you can verify

### Research is ideal for tasks like:

- Market analysis and competitive research
- Planning complex projects, like team offsites or product launches
- Synthesizing information from your email, calendar, and documents
- Creating technical documentation that draws from multiple sources
- Preparing briefings that require current, verified information

### Consider web search instead when:

- You need a quick, specific fact (like today's stock price or a company's address)
- The answer requires only one or two sources
- Speed matters more than comprehensiveness

### Consider extended thinking instead when:

- You need deep reasoning on a complex problem that doesn't require external information
- You're working on mathematical problems, code debugging, or logical analysis
- The answer comes from reasoning through a problem rather than gathering information

### Consider enterprise search instead when:

- You need answers that draw from your organization's internal knowledge — documents, Slack threads, emails, meeting notes
- You're onboarding and want to quickly find how your company handles something (like policies, processes, or past decisions)
- You're asking a question that's specific to your company, not the public web

## How Research works

When you enable Research, you're activating an agentic, multi-step process that goes far beyond a simple web search. Claude autonomously decides what to search next based on what it has already found, pursuing leads and filling gaps without you needing to direct each step.

**Step 1: Claude plans its approach.** When Research is enabled, extended thinking automatically activates. This lets Claude break down your request, identify what information it needs, and plan how to investigate different angles of your question.

**Step 2: Claude conducts multiple searches.** Rather than running a single search, Claude conducts many searches that build on each other. It determines what to investigate next based on what it finds, pursuing promising leads and filling in gaps.

**Step 3: Claude synthesizes findings.** After gathering information from multiple sources—including the web and any connected integrations like Gmail, Google Calendar, or Google Drive—Claude compiles everything into a comprehensive, well-organized report.

**Step 4: Claude provides citations.** Every claim in Research reports links back to its source, making it easy to verify information and dig deeper when needed.

## Using Research in practice

Here's how to enable and use Research:

1. Click the + button on the bottom left of your chat interface
2. Select Research from the menu—it appears highlighted once active
3. Enter your prompt and submit
4. Claude will work in the background, and you'll see progress indicators as it searches and analyzes

**Important:** Web search must be enabled for Research to function. If you haven't already turned on web search, you can do so from the same + menu.

### Tips for effective Research prompts

Since Research can take 5 to 45 minutes depending on complexity, investing time in crafting your prompt pays off. Here are some strategies:

- Be specific about your goals. Instead of "Tell me about the EV market," try "Analyze the electric vehicle battery market—identify key players, technology trends, and supply chain challenges that might affect investment decisions."
- Specify the sections or structure you want. Claude will organize its findings around the structure you provide. For example: "Compare venue options for a team offsite including: location and accessibility, meeting space and amenities, catering options, and pricing considerations."
- Include relevant constraints. Budget ranges, timelines, geographic requirements, and other parameters help Claude focus its research on relevant options.
- Ask Claude to help refine your prompt. If you're not sure how to frame your research question, you can even ask Claude to help you write a better Research prompt before enabling the feature.

### Working with connected integrations

When you have Google Workspace or other integrations connected, Research becomes even more powerful. Claude can pull context from your emails, calendar, and documents alongside web research.

For example, you might ask Claude to:

- "Summarize what's been discussed about Project X across my emails and Slack, then research industry best practices for similar initiatives"
- "Review my calendar commitments for next week and research each company I'm meeting with"
- "Find all internal documents about our pricing strategy and compare to how competitors are positioning themselves"

When using Research with integrations, you can steer Claude by saying things like "Pull relevant context from my Google Drive" or "Include insights from my recent emails on this topic."

**Pro tip:** You can also turn off web search to do internal-only research across your connected tools — great for questions like "What did our team discuss about the Q3 launch across Slack and Docs?"

## Lesson reflection

Before moving on, consider:

- What research tasks in your work typically require gathering information from multiple sources?
- How might combining Research with your connected integrations (like Google Workspace) change your workflow?
- What's a complex question you've been putting off because it would take too much research time?

## What's next

In the next section we're putting it all together. You'll see how everything you've learned comes together through real-world use cases organized by role, and discover additional ways to interact with Claude beyond the web interface.

For more information on Research, including video tutorials, visit the [Anthropic Help Center](#).

## Acknowledgments and license

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